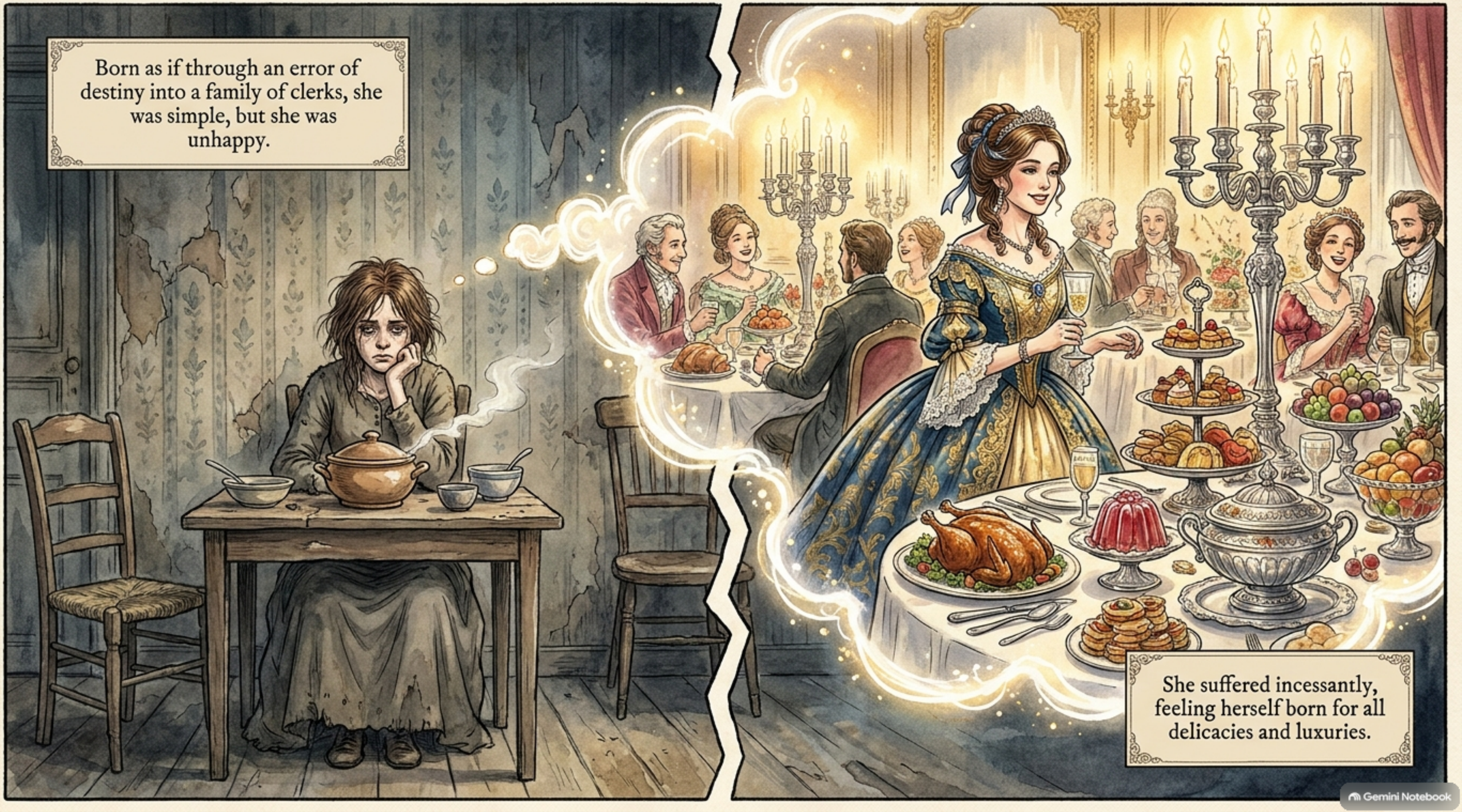
Class 10
English
Master
Revision

THE NECKLACE

By Guy de Maupassant

Gemini Notebook


Born as if through an error of destiny into a family of clerks, she was simple, but she was unhappy.
She suffered incessantly, feeling herself born for all delicacies and luxuries.

Gemini Notebook

It seems to me that four hundred francs ought to cover it.
He had saved exactly this sum to buy a gun to shoot larks on Sundays.
Very well. I will give you four hundred francs. But try to have a pretty dress.

Gemini Notebook

Suddenly she discovered, in a black satin box, a superb necklace of diamonds. Her hands trembled.
Could you lend me this? Only this?
Why, yes, certainly.

The day of the ball arrived. Mme Loisel was a great success. She danced with enthusiasm, intoxicated with pleasure and complete victory.

Paris, 4:00 AM.
I have — I have — I no longer have Mme Forestier's necklace!

They looked everywhere. He went to the police, the cab offices, and put an advertisement in the newspapers.
Write to your friend that you have broken the clasp... That will give us time.

Gemini Notebook

She learned the odious work of a kitchen.
They sent away the maid and rented an attic.
This life lasted for ten years.

Gemini Notebook

Sunday on the event in the Champs-Élysées.
I lost it... and it has taken us ten years to pay for the replacement.
OH! MY POOR MATILDA! MINE WERE FALSE. THEY WERE NOT WORTH OVER FIVE HUNDRED FRANCS!

SUPER REVISION: Characters & Timeline

MATILDA:
Vain, superficial, eternally discontent. Heroic in her eventual hard labor, but ultimately ruined by her own pride.

M. LOISEL:
Content, loving, practical. Self-sacrificing (gave up his gun) and fiercely loyal to his wife's mistakes.

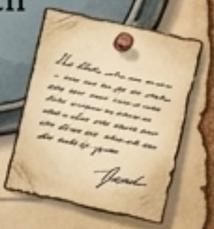
Desire
Discontent with modest life

Borrowing
400-franc dress & borrowed necklace

Loss
Panic after the Minister's Ball

Debt
36,000 francs borrowed; 10 years of grueling labor

Reveal
The 500-franc truth



Gemini Notebook

IMPORTANT VOCABULARY

Incessantly
(Continuously)

Tureen
(Covered soup dish)

Vexation
(State of distress/frustration)

Ruinous
(Disastrous)

Usurers
(High-interest moneylenders)

Awry
(Twisted / not correct)

Gemini Notebook

Le Petit Journal

BOARD EXAM BOOSTER

CORE THEMES

- Contentment vs. Vanity: True happiness comes from within, not from borrowed luxury.
- Honesty: Confessing the truth immediately would have saved 10 years of suffering.
- The Ripple Effect: “How small a thing will ruin or save one!”

CRUCIAL FACTS

- Dress Cost: 400 francs (M. Loisel’s gun savings)
- Real Necklace Cost: 36,000 francs
- Fake Necklace Value: Under 500 francs

TOP EXAM QUESTIONS

1. “What was the cause of Matilda’s ruin? How could she have avoided it?”

2. “Compare and contrast the character traits of M. Loisel and Matilda.”

3. “Comment on the irony of the story’s ending.”

Gemini Notebook